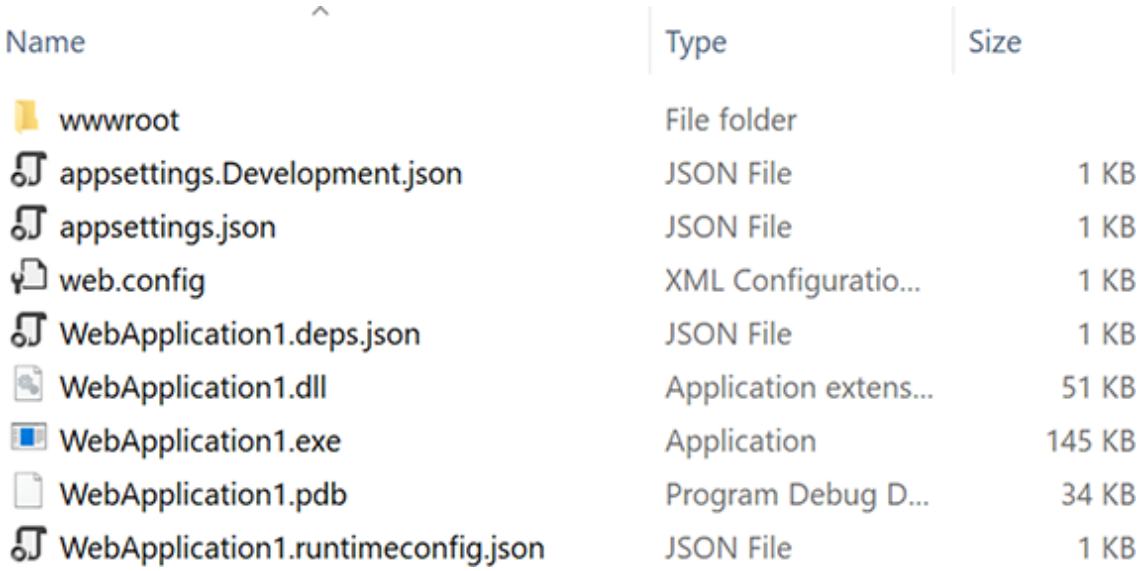


Figure 14.2 The artifacts generated by the publishing process

The contents of the wwwroot folder are copied directly from the original application, as are the app settings files. A web.config file is generated, which is used by IIS to configure the application as a website.

The .exe file is the host for the application and is specific to a particular operating system and architecture. It is not cross-platform and will target the current platform by default, unless you specify an alternative using the Target Runtime option in Visual Studio or the `---runtime` or `-r` option when publishing with the CLI. The actual application is compiled to a .dll file that is named after the project by default. A .pdb file is also generated. This contains information about debug symbols in the application and is only useful if you need to attach a debugger to the application when it is on the live server. If not, you don't need to include the .pdb file when you deploy the application. You can suppress their generation by navigating to the project properties (at the bottom of the Project menu in Visual Studio); go to Build > General, and then select No Symbols Are Emitted from the Debug Symbols option (figure 14.3).